Table 3.1 Examples of instance families and instance types

Instance type	Virtual CPUs	Memory	Description	Typical use case	Monthly cost (USD)
t2.nano	1	0.5 GiB	Small and cheap instance type, with moderate baseline performance and the ability to burst CPU performance above the baseline	Testing and development environments and applications with very low traffic	$4
m6i.large	2	8 GiB	Has a balanced ratio of CPU, memory, and networking performance	All kinds of applications, such as medium databases, web servers, and enterprise applications	$69
r6i.large	2	16 GiB	Optimized for memory-intensive applications with extra memory	In-memory caches and enterprise application servers	$90

Instance families are optimized for different kinds of use cases, as described next:

- *T family*—Cheap, moderate baseline performance with the ability to burst to higher performance for short periods of time
- *M family*—General purpose, with a balanced ration of CPU and memory
- *C family*—Computing optimized, high CPU performance